



chromeos 9p filesystem convert back to msdos

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Converting a ChromeOS 9P Filesystem Back to MS-DOS

If you have a ChromeOS partition formatted with the **9P filesystem** (used for ChromeOS's virtual filesystems) and want to restore it to a **MS-DOS (FAT16/FAT32)** format so it can be used with DOSBox or other DOS tools, you'll need to work in Linux (Crostini) or via a Linux shell on ChromeOS.

Why 9P ≠ MS-DOS

ChromeOS uses 9P to serve files over the network to the OS, so the filesystem is not a traditional disk partition. You can't "convert" it like a raw disk — you must remount it as a regular filesystem in Linux and then reformat it.

Step-by-step in Linux (Crostini)

1. Enable Developer Mode and Linux (Crostini)

- Enable Developer Mode in ChromeOS settings.
- Install Linux (Ubuntu/Debian) via the Linux app or `crosh` → `enable-ash`.
- Install `fdisk` and `mkdosfs`:

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install dosfstools
```

2. Mount the ChromeOS partition

- Identify the partition (e.g., `/dev/sda1` or `/dev/disk/by-label/CHROMEOS`):

```
lsblk
```

- Mount it in read-only to inspect:

```
sudo mkdir /mnt/chromeos
sudo mount -o ro /dev/sda1 /mnt/
chromeos
```

- Check the filesystem type:

```
file -s /mnt/chromeos/
```

If it's 9P, you'll see something like 9P filesystem.

3. Remount as a regular filesystem

- 9P is a virtual filesystem; you need to remount it as a real filesystem (e.g., `ext4`, `NTFS`, or `FAT`) so you can reformat it.
- If you want `FAT32` for DOS compatibility:

```
sudo mkfs.vfat -F 32 /dev/sda1
```

This will erase all data on the partition

 docs.mrchromebox.tech

Firmware Utility Script | MrChromebox.tech

<https://docs.mrchromebox.tech/docs/fwscript.html>

 Reddit

DOSBox-X on ChromeOS: How-To from a noob, for other noobs

https://www.reddit.com/r/chromeos/comments/yauqkc/dosboxx_on_chromeos_howto_from_a_noob_for_other/

This will erase all data on the partition.

4. Reinstall ChromeOS or remount as 9P

- If you want ChromeOS to use it again, you'll need to restore the ChromeOS image to the partition and remount it as 9P via ChromeOS's filesystem setup.

Step-by-step in ChromeOS Shell (Advanced)

- You can run the **ChromeOS Firmware Utility Script** from Linux to inspect and modify firmware, but it won't directly reformat a 9P partition docs.mrchromebox.tech.
- For direct filesystem changes, you must boot into Linux (Crostini) or use a Linux live USB.

Important Notes

- **Data loss:** Reformatting will erase all data on the partition.
- **9P is virtual:** You can't "convert" it to MS-DOS without remounting as a real filesystem.
- If you just need DOS compatibility, consider mounting the ChromeOS partition as a virtual drive in DOSBox-X [Reddit](#) instead of reformatting.

Alternative: Keep 9P, Mount in DOSBox

If you don't need to reformat, you can:

- Mount the ChromeOS partition in Linux Crostini.
- Copy files to a FAT32 partition or USB drive.
- Mount that FAT32 drive in DOSBox-X for DOS applications [Reddit](#).

In short: You can't directly convert a ChromeOS 9P filesystem to MS-DOS without remounting it as a real filesystem in Linux, then reformatting it to FAT32. Use Linux Crostini for this, and be aware of data loss.

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DOSBox-X on ChromeOS: How-To from a noob, for other noobs

So far I've had to re-mount my file for C: drive in DOSBox-X each time I launch it, but this is easy to do with the gui tool bar at the top of the window. Saved games persist across shutdown/remount process.



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Is it possible to install MS-DOS on a Chromebook? - Reddit

I've tried booting MS-DOS off of a USB drive before, using MrChromebox's RW_LEGACY firmware. It freezes up just by doing simple things like pressing the Tab key.

Reviews: 15



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This site is designed to provide background info on ChromeOS, Developer Mode, and Legacy Boot Mode, as well as info on modifying/replacing the firmware on your device in order to better meet your ...

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 Github
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GitHub - google/chromeos-filesystems: Additional file system ...

This repository contains various filesystem providers for Chrome OS. They offer a way to access files stored on remote servers through the Files app, from a variety of sources.

 Google Support
<https://support.google.com> › chromeosflex

Prepare for installation - ChromeOS Flex Help - Google Help

You'll need to boot from the ChromeOS Flex USB installer and make some adjustments in the BIOS if you run into issues. Devices using the following processor/graphics components are not...

 xdaforums.com
<https://xdaforums.com>

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